

PSY 541: Advanced Cognitive Psychology
Spring, 2025
Course Syllabus

Instructor: Dr. David Yells

Office: UC 201

Office hours: M 530-600; W: 200-300; R: 1100-1200

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Course description:

Students will synthesize and analyze classic and contemporary readings in the cognitive sciences and apply their acquired knowledge of the subject to a variety of activities designed to provide firsthand experience in the field of cognitive psychology. Prerequisite: Graduate standing.

Student Learning Outcomes

After completing this course students will

1. Understand the origins and major perspectives of cognitive psychology
2. Know the key biological bases of cognition
3. Understand the nature of attention
4. Understand features of the modal model of memory
5. Know the principles of conceptual knowledge
6. Understand the nature of visual imagery
7. Know the principles of language production comprehension
8. Understand higher cognitive functions such as problem solving and decision making.

Course Calendar

Module 1

Week 1 January 13 Course Introduction, Chapter 1

Week 2 January 20 Chapter 2 PEO 1 Due January 26

Week 3 January 27 Chapter 3 PEO 2 Due February 2

Week 4 February 3 Chapter 4 PEO 3 Due February 9

Module 2

Week 5 February 10 No Class Discussion 1 due February 16; First 5 paper sources due February 16

Week 6 February 17 Chapter 5 PEO 4 DUE February 23

Week 7 February 24 Chapter 6 PEO 5 DUE March 2

Week 8 March 3 Chapter 7 PEO 6 DUE March 9

Module 3

Week 9 March 10 Chapter 8 PEO 7 DUE March 16

Week 10 March 17 SPRING BREAK NO CLASS Discussion 2 due March 29; Second 5 paper sources due March 29

Week 11 March 24 Chapter 9 PEO 8 DUE March 30

Week 12 March 31 Chapter 10 PEO 9 DUE April 6

Module 4

Week 13 April 7 NO CLASS Discussion 3 due April 19; outline for final paper due April 19

Week 14 April 14 Chapter 11 PEO 10 DUE April 20

Week 15 April 21 Chapter 12 PEO 11 DUE APRIL 27; final paper due April 27

Week 16 April 28 Chapter 13 PEO 12 DUE May 4

Week 17 May 5 (Finals Week) PEO 13 DUE May 7

Methods of Evaluation

Point Earning Opportunities (PEOS)

Each week you will have an opportunity to earn points towards your final grade by demonstrating your knowledge of course material. PEOs look like quizzes, but they are actually an opportunity for you to earn points toward your final grade. There is a partial sample PEO in the quiz section of the course for you to take before the first real one. Each PEO will include approximately 15 multiple choice items and will be worth 30 points. You will have 20 minutes to complete a PEO. That is more than one minute per item which is pretty long. PEOs make up almost 40% of your grade.

Discussion Posts

Some weeks I will post information on recent research in psychopharmacology. You must respond directly to the prompt and support your post with one additional source. A single, well-written paragraph or two should suffice. There is a sample discussion post in the **course files section of the course**.

Term Paper

Each student will prepare an 8 page term paper (literature review) on a topic relevant to cognitive psychology. A minimum of 10 recent (within the last 5 years) peer reviewed journal articles must be used. This is worth 420 course points (40 % of your grade). If the topic is clearly and explicitly related to psychopharmacology, you don't need instructor approval for your topic. If you are not sure, check with

me. **There is a sample paper available in the course files section. I am happy to review drafts of your final paper prior to submission for grade. I do not guarantee I can make your paper perfect. I do guarantee you will get a better grade.**

Paper Sources

You need to have your sources approved by me. You will submit them in two batches of five. A sample of a reference list is available **in the course resources folder**. These assignments may be repeated until you earn full credit (60 points). Remember, sources must be peer-reviewed journal articles from within the past 5 years. There is a video in the course files section explaining how to search for sources in the TAMUT library.

Paper Outline

You must submit a one-page outline of your paper. A sample outline is available in the **course files section**. This assignment may be repeated until you earn full credit (20 points).

Methods of Evaluation

Point Earning Opportunities (PEOS)

Most weeks you will have an opportunity to earn points towards your final grade by demonstrating your knowledge of course material. PEOs look like quizzes, but they are actually an opportunity for you to earn points. There is a partial sample PEO in the quiz section of the course for you to take before the first real one. Each PEO will include approximately 15 multiple choice items and will be worth 30 points. You will have 20 minutes to complete a PEO. That is more than one minute per item which is pretty long. PEOs make up more than 40% of your grade.

Discussion Posts

Some weeks I will post information on recent research in cognition. You must respond directly to the prompt and support your post with one additional source. A single, well-written paragraph or two should suffice. There is a sample discussion post in the **course files section of the course**.

Term Paper

Each student will prepare an 8 page term paper (literature review) on a topic relevant to cognitive psychology. A minimum of 10 recent (within the last 5 years)

peer reviewed journal articles must be used. This is worth 480 course points (48% of your grade). If the topic is clearly and explicitly related to cognitive psychology, you don't need instructor approval for your topic. If you are not sure, check with me. **There is a sample paper available in the course files section. I am happy to review drafts of your final paper prior to submission for grade. I do not guarantee I can make your paper perfect. I do guarantee you will get a better grade if you take advantage of the rough draft option.**

Paper Sources

You need to have your sources approved by me. You will submit them in two batches of five. A sample of a reference list is available **in the course resources folder**. These assignments may be repeated until you earn full credit (50 points). Remember, sources must be peer-reviewed journal articles from within the past 5 years. There is a video in the course files section explaining how to search for sources in the TAMUT library.

Paper Outline

You must submit a one-page outline of your paper. A sample outline is available in the **course files section**. This assignment may be repeated until you earn full credit (20 points).

Grading Breakdown

PEOs:	390
13 at 30 points each	
Main Discussion posts:	60
3 at 20 points each	
Sources for Paper	50
Outline for paper:	20
<u>Paper:</u>	<u>480</u>

TOTAL : **1000 points**

Grading Scale

900 + points:	A
800-899 points:	B
700-799 points:	C
600-699 points:	D
<600 points:	F

Disability Accommodations: The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a federal non-discrimination statute that provides comprehensive civil rights protection for persons with disabilities. Among other things, this law requires that all students with disabilities be guaranteed a learning environment that provides for reasonable accommodation of their disabilities. If you believe you have a disability requiring an accommodation, please contact the Office of Student Life in UC room 126, or call (903)223-3116. For additional information visit [Disability Services](#)***.

Academic Integrity: Academic honesty is expected of students enrolled in this course. Cheating on examinations, unauthorized collaboration, falsification of research data, plagiarism, and undocumented use of materials from any source constitute academic dishonesty and may be grounds for a grade of ‘F’ in the course and/or disciplinary actions. For additional information, see the university catalog.

A&M-Texarkana Email Address: Upon application to Texas A&M University-Texarkana an individual will be assigned an A&M-Texarkana email account. This email account will be used to deliver official university correspondence. Each individual is responsible for information sent and received via the university email account and is expected to check the official A&M-Texarkana email account on a frequent and consistent basis.

Drop Policy: To drop this course after the census date, a student must complete a Drop/Withdrawal Request Form, located on the University Registrar’s webpage or obtained in the Registrar’s Office. The student must submit the signed and completed form to the instructor of each course indicated on the form to be dropped for his/her signature. The signature is not an “approval” to drop, but rather confirmation that the student has discussed the drop/withdrawal with the faculty member. The form must be submitted to the Registrar’s office for processing in person, email Registrar@tamut.edu, mail (7101 University Ave., Texarkana, TX 75503) or fax (903-223-3140). Drop/withdraw forms missing any of the required information will not be accepted by the Registrar’s Office for

processing. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that the form is completed properly before submission. If a student stops participating in class (attending and submitting assignments) but does not complete and submit the drop/withdrawal form, a final grade based on work completed as outlined in the syllabus will be assigned.